

[Report 025] Databricks - Sr. Engagement Manager (Munich)

Score: 3.0/5

URL: https://databricks.com/company/careers/open-positions/job?gh_jid=8543937002

PDF: 

Legitimacy: High Confidence

Verification: confirmed (WebFetch)

Date: 2026-05-21

A) ROLE SUMMARY

Dimension	Detail
Archetype	AI Forward Deployed (primary) / Technical AI PM (secondary)
Domain	Data & AI platform, professional services, enterprise delivery
Function	Lead Forward Deployed Engineering motion for DACH/region; align services into platform deals; mentor delivery managers; strategic advisory to executives
Seniority	Senior - regional leadership of the FDE motion, mentoring junior managers
Remote	Hybrid - Munich base; ~20% customer travel
Team size	Not specified; manages/mentors junior engagement managers
TL;DR	Own the Forward Deployed Engineering go-to-motion for a region: attach professional services to Databricks platform deals, act as exec-level trusted advisor to strategic accounts, and mentor the delivery team.

B) MATCH WITH CV

JD Requirement	CV Evidence	Strength
Lead FDE motion across a business unit or region	Closest: Spark! Living Lab (led innovation motion across Windesheim); Value Chain Hackers (led cross-European applied AI initiative); Viridis (innovation lab leadership)	Moderate - lab leadership, not FDE in a PS sense
Align closely with Sales, Delivery, and Field Engineering leadership	COTIT: aligned sales, ops, and tech; Tonomy Foundation: co-led across product, sales, engineering	Moderate
Drive adoption of service offerings; integrate services into platform deals	Indirect: blockchain training programs embedded into partner organizations (2bSMART); Windesheim AI stack embedded in academic delivery	Moderate - adoption driving, not commercial services
Trusted advisor to executives and strategic partner to account teams	KONGSBERG: C-suite escalation during BP/Statoil data contract crisis (went to CEO); Social Chicken BI/cloud work for SME owners	Moderate - exec interaction, not recurring advisory relationship
Architecture-level discussions and translate technical designs into business outcomes	DevOps (Docker, Kubernetes, Linux, CI/CD, Oracle SOA); self-hosted AI stack design; KONGSBERG BI deployments	Moderate - infrastructure-level, not data platform architecture
Deep data and AI domain expertise	Self-hosted AI stack (Flowise, OpenWebUI, n8n, Supabase); VCH AI supply chain mapping; AI stack deployment for student/researcher use	Moderate - practitioner level, not Databricks/Spark/MLflow depth
Professional services leadership background	KONGSBERG field service; Windesheim project management; Social Chicken multi-client delivery	Moderate - delivery track record, not PS team management

Mentor junior managers; manage team	Managed student teams and junior practitioners; co-founded and structured Tonomy; Aeres Lab management	Moderate
Program management capabilities	Prince2, ITIL, COVID-19 mega project, multi-lab management	Strong
Excellent communication and negotiation skills	Albert Cuyp (crowd-reading), Train-the-Trainer, KONGSBERG CEO escalation, international client deployments	Strong
~20% customer travel	From Baarn, NL to Munich: periodic travel feasible (2-3h flight); not daily commute	Acceptable
Data & AI domain; Databricks platform knowledge	Not present - no Databricks, Spark, Delta Lake, MLflow, or Lakehouse experience listed	Hard Gap

Gaps:

Gap	Blocker?	Mitigation
Databricks / Spark / Delta Lake / Lakehouse platform knowledge	Hard blocker (preferred = effectively required for this level)	No quick mitigation; self-study possible but would be detected in architecture-level interviews
Commercial PS delivery leadership (quota/revenue ownership)	Significant gap	Project management and lab leadership are real but different from owning a PS bookings number
Munich-based or DACH market presence	Moderate	Viridis (Munich-based employer) gives DACH connection; German conversational competency is a partial mitigant
German language fluency	Moderate	Conversational German - Munich/DACH client conversations would require more; English likely accepted internally but client-facing in Germany favors German fluency
Managing a team of PS managers	Moderate	Indirect evidence only (lab management, co-founding) - not formal PS people management

C) LEVEL AND STRATEGY

Level detected: Senior Engagement Manager with regional leadership scope - effectively a PS business unit lead for the DACH/Munich region. This is a more senior and commercially-oriented role than the title suggests.

Candidate's natural level: Program Manager / Lab Lead / Applied AI Practitioner. Christiaan can operate at the delivery and advisory level, but the commercial PS motion (attaching services to platform deals, owning FDE motion as a revenue driver) is a different game.

Sell senior without lying:

- If applying: lead with the KONGSBERG CEO escalation story - "I've operated at exec level in high-stakes delivery contexts" (data contract crisis, oil rig, no internet, CEO escalation).
- Frame the Viridis/Munich connection: "I currently work with a Munich-based organization - I understand the DACH market and the cultural context for German technical stakeholders."
- Lead with the applied AI practitioner identity: "I build and run AI infrastructure. I'm not a theorist - here's the stack."
- The DM/facilitation identity is genuinely relevant for the "trusted advisor" framing: "I design experiences that make complex systems navigable - that's what executive advisory is."

Honest assessment: The Databricks platform gap is significant for a company that sells exclusively on its own platform. An engagement manager at this level needs to be able to lead architecture discussions involving Spark, Delta Lake, Unity Catalog, MLflow - these are not generic data concepts, they are Databricks-specific. This is learnable but not quickly enough for a senior role interview.

If downleveled to Engagement Manager (non-senior): Still has the Databricks platform gap. However, at the non-senior level the advisory depth requirement decreases and the program management / facilitation skills become more

prominent. Worth exploring if the company would consider a junior EM level with a learning trajectory.

D) COMP AND DEMAND

Data Point	Finding	Source
Databricks Engagement Manager Munich	Estimated €90,000-€130,000 base; significant equity (RSUs); strong bonus	Glassdoor, Levels.fyi
Databricks total comp reputation	Databricks is known for top-quartile comp; one of the highest-paying data companies	Levels.fyi
Sr. Engagement Manager vs. market	Above market for PS roles; reflects Databricks' premium positioning	General knowledge
Demand trend	Databricks growing rapidly (pre-IPO, \$43B+ valuation); DACH expansion active	Public company info

Assessment: This is financially a very attractive role - likely at the top of or above Christiaan's target range (€65k-€90k), potentially reaching €100k+ with bonus/equity. However, the compensation attractiveness should not override the structural gaps. The platform knowledge gap would surface in technical interviews.

E) CUSTOMIZATION PLAN

#	Section	Current Status	Proposed Change	Why
1	Professional Summary	Lab builder / bridge builder	Add: "applied data and AI practitioner, deployed AI infrastructure across research and educational contexts" - shift toward practitioner language	FDE motion requires demonstrated hands-on AI delivery
2	Windesheim AI Stack	"Set up and maintained AI sandbox"	Reframe: "Designed and operated a self-hosted AI delivery environment (Flowise, OpenWebUI, n8n, Supabase) for 50+ researchers and students - from architecture to adoption"	Maps to FDE practitioner framing
3	KONGSBERG section	Field Service Engineer	Add: "Operated as trusted technical advisor and escalation point for C-suite during high-stakes data contract crisis across BP and Statoil implementations"	Exec advisory proof point
4	Viridis	Munich-based employer	Explicitly note: "Munich-based client; familiar with DACH market and German technical stakeholder culture"	Mitigates the Munich-base preference
5	Skills section	AI/Open Infrastructure listed	Add "Data Platform Architecture" even if at the stack-agnostic level; list specific tools	ATS and recruiter scanability for data roles

Critical gap to address before applying: Complete Databricks Academy fundamentals (Databricks Fundamentals + Data Engineering Associate certification - both free and can be completed in days). This would not make the platform gap disappear but demonstrates intent and basic familiarity.

F) INTERVIEW PLAN

#	JD Requirement	Story	S	T	A	R	Reflection
1	Trusted advisor to executives	KONGSBERG CEO Escalation	BP Azerbaijan data contract breach; oil rig deployment; no internet fallback	Escalate without permission to protect the project	Read the contract, identified the breach, escalated directly to the CEO (not through	CEO confirmed the breach; contract renegotiated; deployment saved	When the chain of command fails the project, you have to go above it - but you

					normal channels)		need to be right
2	Lead FDE motion; attach services to platform deals	Windesheim AI Stack	Researchers needed AI tools; Windesheim IT had no budget or appetite to provide them	Build and deploy a working AI environment as a proof-of-concept that enables the "attach"	Self-funded the initial stack; ran workshops to build internal demand; the demand became the justification for institutional adoption	Active researcher and student use; later adopted informally into the curriculum	Demand creation before budget request - show the value first, ask for money second
3	Architecture-level discussions translating technical to business	Value Chain Hackers	SMEs needed CSRD/EUDR compliance tooling but couldn't afford enterprise solutions	Design a lightweight, open-source architecture that a non-technical SME could actually use	Built AI supply chain mapping tool on open infrastructure; translated regulatory requirements into data flows; presented to non-technical supply chain managers	Active use at Windesheim; adopted by cross-European partners	The best architecture is the one the user can understand - not the most elegant one
4	Program management across concurrent engagements	COVID-19 Mega Project	8 courses needed to merge in under 2 months	Manage the integration as a program across 8 stakeholders with competing priorities	Prince2 program structure; daily check-ins; ran the merged sprint track from design to delivery	Successfully delivered; model adopted post-pandemic	Multiple concurrent stakeholders is a negotiation problem, not a scheduling problem
5	Mentoring junior managers	Open Food Chain / Spark! Lab	Students and junior contributors needed direction without becoming dependent	Design mentorship as system design - give them the framework, let them build	Created sprint structures, facilitated retrospectives, designed the work to create visibility	Multiple students and contributors became independent practitioners	Good mentorship makes the mentor dispensable - that's the goal

Red-flag questions:

- "What's your Databricks experience?" → "Practitioner level on the AI stack (Flowise, n8n, Supabase), not Databricks-specific. I've started the Databricks Academy fundamentals. I bring the delivery and advisory motion - the platform depth is a 60-day ramp."
- "This is a Munich-based role - are you relocating?" → "I work with a Munich-based organization currently (Viridis) and visit regularly. I'm open to a hybrid model that doesn't require a move - periodic travel to Munich is fully manageable from my base in the Netherlands."
- "Do you have PS quota experience?" → "Not quota-carrying in the traditional sense - but I've owned end-to-end delivery outcomes and attached services (training, enablement, tooling) to organizational adoption. The commercial framing is new; the delivery ownership is not."

Case study recommendation: KONGSBERG BP/Statoil - positions Christiaan as a client-facing, exec-level delivery practitioner in a high-stakes environment. Memorable and differentiating because most PMs have never been on an oil rig fixing a data contract breach.

G) POSTING LEGITIMACY

Assessment: High Confidence

Signal	Finding	Weight
Posting freshness	Job ID 8543937002 - Databricks Greenhouse board; API returned content	Positive
Apply button	Live	Positive
Description quality	Specific about the FDE motion, mentoring scope, and regional leadership; names Databricks as the platform; realistic seniority requirements	Positive
Company growth signals	Databricks is pre-IPO, \$43B+ valuation, actively expanding DACH; Munich office growing	Strongly positive
Reposting pattern	No prior scan history	Neutral
Role-company fit	Databricks needs regional PS leaders as it scales; Sr. Engagement Manager Munich is exactly the hire they would make at this growth stage	Strongly positive
~20% travel specified	Realistic for a Munich-based role with regional scope	Positive

Context Notes: This is a genuine opening at a high-growth company in an active expansion phase. No concerns about legitimacy. The mismatch is with Christiaan's current platform depth, not with the posting itself.

KEYWORDS EXTRACTED

engagement manager, forward deployed engineering, professional services, Databricks, data platform, AI, Munich, DACH, program management, trusted advisor, executive advisory, delivery leadership, services attach, platform adoption, mentoring, GSI partners, cloud providers, Data & AI, lakehouse, stakeholder management, architecture

JOB DESCRIPTION (ARCHIVED)

Archived 2026-05-21 - original posting may be removed after offer closes

Title: Sr. Engagement Manager

Company: Databricks

Location: Munich, Germany

Department: Professional Services Operations

URL: https://databricks.com/company/careers/open-positions/job?gh_jid=8543937002

This role leads the Forward Deployed Engineering motion across a business unit or region. The position combines technical expertise with sales alignment, serving as a trusted advisor to executives and strategic partner to account teams.

Key Responsibilities:

The successful candidate will "lead the Forward Deployed Engineering motion in your region, aligning closely with Sales, Delivery, and Field Engineering leadership." Additional duties include driving adoption of service offerings, integrating services into platform deals, and acting as a bridge between technical and commercial teams.

The role emphasizes mentoring junior managers, collaborating with partners like GSIs and cloud providers, and demonstrating technical depth in data and AI platforms. The position involves approximately 20% customer travel.

Required Qualifications:

Candidates should possess strong customer-facing experience in consulting and solutioning roles, with the ability to "engage in architecture-level discussions and translate technical designs into business outcomes." Deep industry expertise, professional services leadership background, and solid knowledge of data platforms are essential.

The ideal candidate combines excellent communication and negotiation skills with program management capabilities and experience in the Data & AI domain.

About Databricks:

Databricks serves as "the data and AI company," with over 10,000 organizations relying on its Data Intelligence Platform, including more than half the Fortune 500.